

17. The fair form of one that is dear hath Frashaoshtra Hvogva promised unto me :<sup>1</sup> may sovran Mazdah Ahura grant that she attain possession of the Right for her good Self.

18. This creed Jamaspa Hvogva<sup>2</sup> chooses through Right, lordly in substance.<sup>3</sup> This Dominion they (choose) who have part in Good Thought. This grant me, Ahura, that they may find in thee, Mazdah, their protection.

19. This man,<sup>4</sup> O Maidyoimaongha Spitama,<sup>5</sup> hath set this before him after conceiving it in his own Self. He that would see Life indeed, to him will he make known what in actions by Mazdah's ordinance is better during (this) existence.

20. Your blessings shall ye give us, all ye that are one in will, with whom Right, Good Thought, Piety, and Mazdah (are one), according to promise, giving your aid when worshipped with reverence.

21. By Piety the beneficent man benefits<sup>6</sup> the Right through his thinking, his words, his action, his Self. By Good Thought Mazdah Ahura will give the Dominion. For this good Destiny<sup>7</sup> I long.

22. He, I ween, that Mazdah Ahura knoweth, among all that have been and are, as one to whom in accordance with

<sup>1</sup> Hvôvi, the daughter of Frashaoshtra : see p. 82. The possibilities of these Gathic problems are well illustrated here by Geldner's version, "Einen begehrenswerten Leib hat mir F. H. für seine gute Seele ausgemalt." He notes "D. h. er hat ihm geschildert, welchen schönen Leib er im Paradies für seine gläubige Seele erbittet : vgl. Ys 36<sup>6</sup>," where prayer is offered for the "fairest of all bodies," to be the worshipper's portion. The reference to the Prophet's new bride seems *a priori* probable in a stanza referring to his father-in-law, and Bartholomae's rendering seems to me preferable. A passage from the Gatha Haptanghaiti is not the best of parallels for the elucidation of the older Gathas.

<sup>2</sup> Frashaoshtra's brother, and Zarathushtra's son-in-law—see Ys 53.

<sup>3</sup> Geldner joins *istōiṣ xšaθrəm*, "das Reich des Wunsches," the looked-for Kingdom of God.

<sup>4</sup> M. himself (Bartholomae).

<sup>5</sup> *Maidyōi-mānha*, a cousin of the Prophet, and his earliest convert, according to tradition. See p. 82.

<sup>6</sup> *Spəntō—spəntat*. Bartholomae, who will not allow "beneficent" as the meaning of *spənta*—on which see p. 145—regards this as a paronomasia. He renders "By Piety one becomes holy. Such a man advances Right by . . .," etc. So now Brugmann, *Grundriss*<sup>2</sup>, II. iii. 329.

<sup>7</sup> *vanhvīm ašim* : see note on v. 10.